

YOUR BOARDROOM DOESN'T NEED AN ACCOUNTANT. IT NEEDS A FINANCE LEADER.



There is a difference — a bloody big one. Qualifications matter, but we've spent far too long confusing being qualified to account for a business with being qualified to help lead one. Immaculate management accounts and a balance sheet reconciled to the penny are admirable. They're not the same thing as driving the business forward.

THE ACCOUNTANT	THE FINANCE LEADER
Arrives at 8:30, disappears behind the Finance door.	Everywhere — talking to Sales, understanding Operations, annoying Marketing.
Immaculate management accounts, reconciled to the penny.	Speaks to customers, asks questions, actually understands how the business works.
Sales call them "the guy from Accounts".	People tell them things before decisions are made.
Marketing aren't entirely convinced they've actually met.	Involved before the expensive call, not explaining it afterwards.
Nobody outside Finance knows their name.	Commercial instinct, relationships and influence, not just controls.

THE NUMBERS TELL YOU WHAT

Margin fell. Aged debt is rising. Headcount is up. The P&L, the debtor ledger and the payroll report each state a fact — reliably, and after it's already happened.

PEOPLE TELL YOU WHY

Credit Control knows why customers aren't paying. Operations knows why one team is drowning while another has time to spare. The spreadsheet doesn't gossip — people do, and only to leaders they know and trust.

WHY THIS MATTERS AT THE BOARD TABLE

People tell things to finance leaders they know and trust. That's how Finance gets involved before an expensive decision is made — not afterwards, explaining why it was expensive.

So yes, give me brilliant accountants — technical expertise, controls, compliance and accurate reporting. But at the boardroom table, give me someone with commercial instinct, curiosity, operational understanding, relationships and influence too — someone who understands the numbers *and* the business that creates them. Those things don't come printed on a certificate.

**BEING QUALIFIED TO ACCOUNT FOR A BUSINESS
AND QUALIFIED TO LEAD ONE ARE NOT THE SAME THING.**